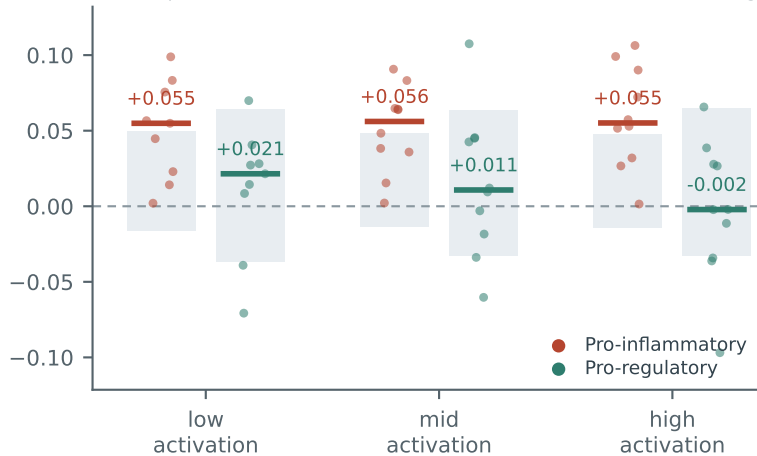


CSF – blood, paired within donor

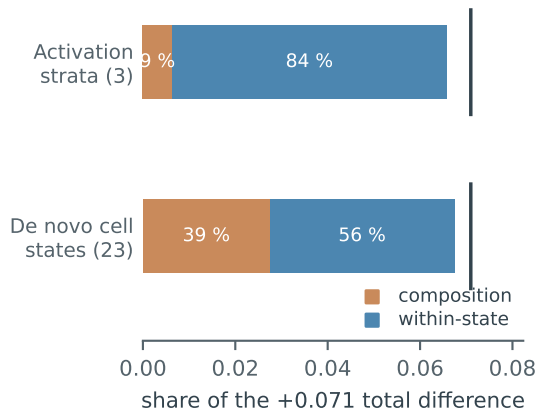
A The elevation is the same at every activation level

one dot per donor · bar = median · shaded = 95 % of matched random gene sets



B Independent states reveal a mix

vertical rule = total · Kitagawa split, exact



GSE138266, 10 donors contributing paired CSF and blood; donor is the unit. Activation is scored from 21 genes disjoint from both modules. In A the activation score itself is flat within strata (empirical p 0.66–0.92), so the strata are activation-matched; the pro-inflammatory arm does not reach